

KIT 5 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF · RUN KIT 1 FIRST

AI & Academic Integrity: Setting Clear Expectations with Students

Everything you need before you present. Read this once (about 8 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist, and you're ready.

What this session is

The session every faculty asks for. Staff learn what the evidence actually says about students, AI, and cheating (calmer than the headlines), get a three-lane framework that turns "is this cheating?" into a label printed on every assignment, learn four assignment upgrades that make honest work the easy path, and practice a curiosity-first script for the conversation nobody enjoys. The 19-minute lab has every teacher build the integrity plan for **a real assignment they're about to give**: its lane, its AI Box in student language, one design change, and their own first two sentences for a suspected-use conversation.

THE STANCE: REPEAT IT UNTIL IT'S FURNITURE

Clarity beats policing. Every assignment names its lane, honesty about AI use is taught like a skill, and no accusation ever rests on a detector score alone.

Why the stakes are worth it: 54% of teens use AI for schoolwork (Pew, 2026) while guidance lags far behind adoption (RAND, 2025), so most students are guessing at the rules. Meanwhile Stanford's before-and-after surveys found self-reported cheating flat at 60–70% across ChatGPT's arrival (Lee, Pope et al., 2024): the integrity problem is older than the bot, and the fix is clarity, not panic.

Who should present it

Same bar as Kits 1–4: any confident colleague. You don't need to be a discipline expert or a technologist; the evidence is quoted for you and the conversation script is written to be read aloud. What you must hold firmly is the detector line. If someone advocates buying detection software, the answer is the evidence on slide 7, delivered kindly: OpenAI shut down its own detector for low accuracy, and commercial detectors flagged over half of real essays by non-native English speakers as AI. This session replaces scores with process.

One prep item matters most: the pre-session email. The lab only works if people arrive with a real assignment they'll give in the next two weeks. Send the one-liner in the checklist below at least two days ahead. Second item: if your school has an existing academic-integrity or AI policy, skim it first; today's lanes and boxes should slot inside it, and where they conflict, your policy wins until leadership updates it.

The session at a glance

Segment	Minutes	What happens
Welcome & the elephant	0:00–0:05	54% of teens use AI; cheating rate flat at 60–70%; panic is not a policy
What's actually happening	0:05–0:12	Why students cheat; the two traps: pretend bans and detector policing
The three lanes	0:12–0:20	Lane framework, one-line labels, the AI Box + Disclosure block templates, practice calls
Four upgrades + the conversation	0:20–0:30	Four assignment upgrades; the curiosity-first script; the never list; ICAI values
Lab: your next assignment	0:30–0:49	Lane → AI Box (from the template) → one upgrade → your two sentences
Making it stick	0:49–0:54	Honest limits; three commitments; where the 30-day plan takes it
First 48 hours & close	0:54–0:56	Action sheet + exit ticket

Core session is 56 minutes. For a 45-minute slot: two practice calls instead of four, two share-out voices, box = lane line + disclosure line only; the script marks the cuts.

Your 15-minute prep checklist

- ☐ **Send the staff email** (2 min, two days ahead): "Bring one real assignment you'll give in the next two weeks, in any subject. You'll leave with its AI rules written and ready to hand out."
- ☐ **Skim your school's existing integrity/AI policy** (3 min): today slots inside it; flag any conflicts for leadership rather than resolving them live.
- ☐ **Skim the script once** (6 min): the detector evidence on slide 7 and the conversation on slides 15–16 are the heart; read those aloud once.
- ☐ **Click through the deck** (2 min): confirm all 30 slides display.
- ☐ **Print the handouts** (2 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours, Exit Ticket, one of each per person.

Room, tech & timing

Same setup as Kits 1–4: projector, pair seating, a visible clock. Wi-Fi is optional today; the lab is thinking and writing, and paper works fine. Timing discipline: the lab must start by 0:30. Cut discussion before you ever cut the lab; the one thing you never cut is slides 16–17, the never list and what integrity protects. Expect real feelings in this session: someone has been burned by a cheating case, and someone is quietly worried they've accused wrongly. The script's tone, curiosity over accusation, is for the adults too.

Facilitator FAQ

"Shouldn't we just buy a detector and be done?"

The evidence says no. OpenAI retired its own detector within six months "due to its low rate of accuracy" (26% catch rate, 9% false flags on human writing), and Stanford researchers found seven commercial detectors flagged over half of real essays by non-native English speakers as AI-generated. A tool that discriminates against your multilingual learners and misses most AI text is not a policy; it's a lawsuit with a subscription fee. Process evidence, drafts, conversations, and in-class writing stand up. Scores don't.

"Isn't lane 3 just teaching them to cheat?"

Lane 3 grades the judgment, not the output: the prompts, the questioning, the improvements. Those are the skills adults get hired for, and they're invisible under a ban. A student who can show you how they directed, doubted, and improved an AI draft is demonstrably thinking. That's the opposite of cheating.

"What about our district's existing policy?"

It wins, always. Today's frameworks live inside whatever policy exists: lanes and boxes are classroom-level clarity, not policy replacement. Where a conflict appears, note it and hand it to leadership; Kit 15 (acceptable-use policy) is where policy itself gets built.

"A parent says another student used AI and got a better grade. Now what?"

The lane label is your answer: "On that assignment, AI assistance was allowed and disclosed; here's the box that went home on the assignment sheet." Clear printed expectations turn a fairness complaint into a shared document. That's why the box is printed, not spoken.

After the session: 5 minutes

- Collect exit tickets; they double as PD documentation.
- Skim the "gray area I still want answered" responses; they set follow-up #2's calibration case.
- Note which lanes dominated by department; wildly different mixes are normal and worth a PLC conversation, not a correction.

© Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi · AI-Ready School. Licensed for use within the purchasing school. This resource is provided for informational purposes by educators, not attorneys, and is not legal advice. Consult your district's legal counsel before adopting any policy.